

Hoon Cho

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EDUCATION

New York University (NYU)

Master of Science in Computer Science

- GPA: 3.93/4.00; Merit Scholarship

Brooklyn, NY

Sep 2024 – May 2026

The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (HKUST)

Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Science

- First Class Honors; 4-Year Full Tuition Scholarship; Dean's List

Hong Kong

Sep 2018 – May 2024

WORK EXPERIENCE

NYU IDEA Lab (PI: Emily Black)

Research Assistant

New York, NY

Jun 2025 – Jun 2026

- Built a reproducible evaluation pipeline benchmarking LLMs against traditional ML on high-stakes social prediction, implementing multiple tabular feature-serialization and prompt/response-elicitation schemes
- Designed a prompt-perturbation framework to quantify prediction and reasoning instability, comparing LLM explanations against SHAP feature importances via Jaccard similarity

LG Uplus (Major Telecom Company)

Data Scientist Intern

Seoul, Korea

Jun 2025 – Aug 2025

- Built an end-to-end ML training and evaluation pipeline with feature selection and hyperparameter optimization for IVR intent prediction, achieving 72.1% top-3 accuracy
- Applied SHAP-based clustering to identify IVR menu consolidation opportunities, improving top-3 accuracy by an additional 2.3%

VDX

Software Engineering Intern

Hong Kong

Jun 2023 – Jul 2023

- Built and deployed a cloud-hosted RAG document QA service using Next.js, Flask, Docker, Nginx, and AWS EC2 for secure internal use
- Evaluated open-source LLMs up to 13B parameters for code generation, text generation, and document analysis to support internal model selection

Republic of Korea Army

Squad Leader & Translator

Anyang, Korea

Dec 2020 – Jun 2022

- Built a Chrome extension with DOM scraping to streamline translation workflows, increasing throughput by 6%

PROJECTS

USThing

Backend Lead

Hong Kong

Nov 2022 – Jan 2024

- Maintained production and testing infrastructure for a student [app](#) serving 15,000+ monthly and 5,000+ daily active users across iOS and Android
- Built NestJS and MongoDB backend services for authentication, admin access control, and file-management APIs
- Developed an Express.js REST API proxy for the HKUST library booking system

Florise (NYU Tandon 2025 Capstone Semi-Finalist)

Backend Developer

New York, NY

Apr 2025

- Built backend APIs for an AI-powered career discovery app (gamified daily missions, personalized guidance) using Node.js, Express.js, and MongoDB, integrated with a React Native (Expo) client

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, C++, Java, SQL

Web & Full-Stack: React, React Native (Expo), Next.js, Node.js, NestJS, Express.js, Flask, REST APIs

Databases & Big Data: MongoDB, MySQL, BigQuery, PySpark, Hadoop

ML & Data Science: PyTorch, TensorFlow, scikit-learn, Hugging Face, Pandas, NumPy, SHAP

Cloud & DevOps: GCP, AWS, Docker, Nginx, Git, Linux